

The AI workspace for immigration operations

One shared case workspace for companies, employees, and counsel - automating the operational layer around every immigration case.

MVP live

5 paying pilots

Trip.com paid pilot

Investor deck | Summer 2026

Sammy Abdella, CEO

PROBLEM

Immigration ops is run like a 1999 inbox

Cases are coordinated across documents, emails, Slack, HR systems, portals, and government notices.

1

Fragmented truth

No single workspace for employer, employee, and counsel. Evidence and decisions live in scattered threads.

2

Expensive bottlenecks

Lawyers spend time on operational work: document review, intake, chasing evidence, summaries, and handoffs.

3

Hidden risk

Compliance, travel, renewal, and missing-evidence issues surface late - when delays are costly.



Immigration is not a filing event. It is a recurring operating system.

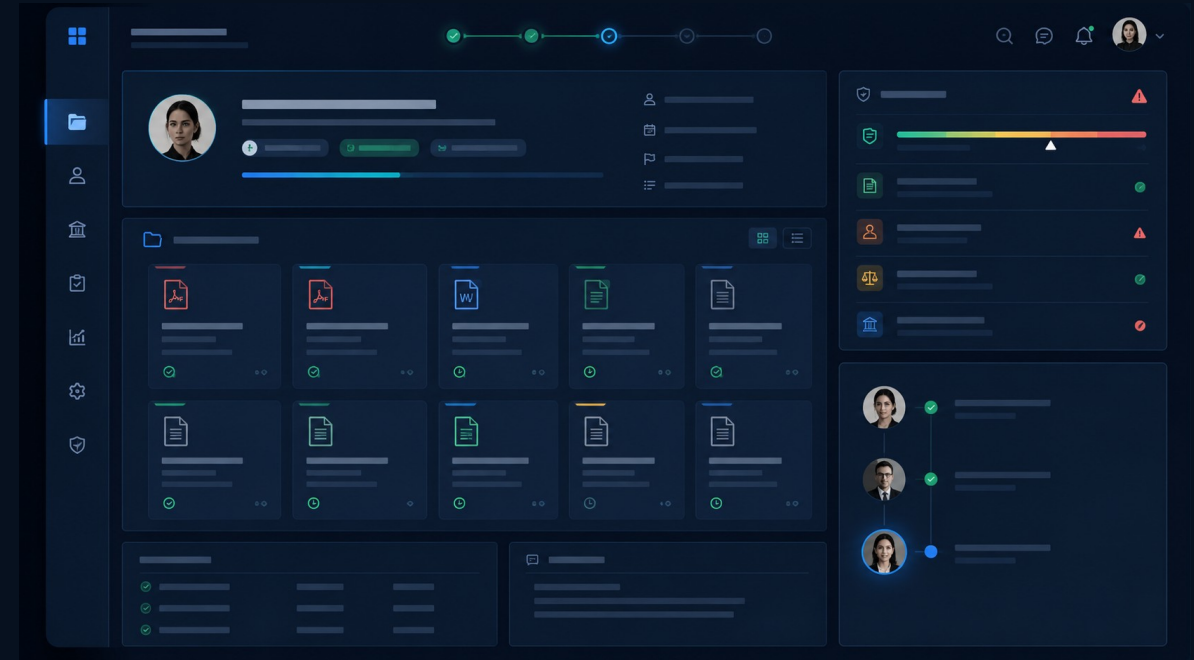
PRODUCT

One shared workspace. One AI ops agent.

Ellis gives every case a system of record and automates the work that currently happens in the seams.

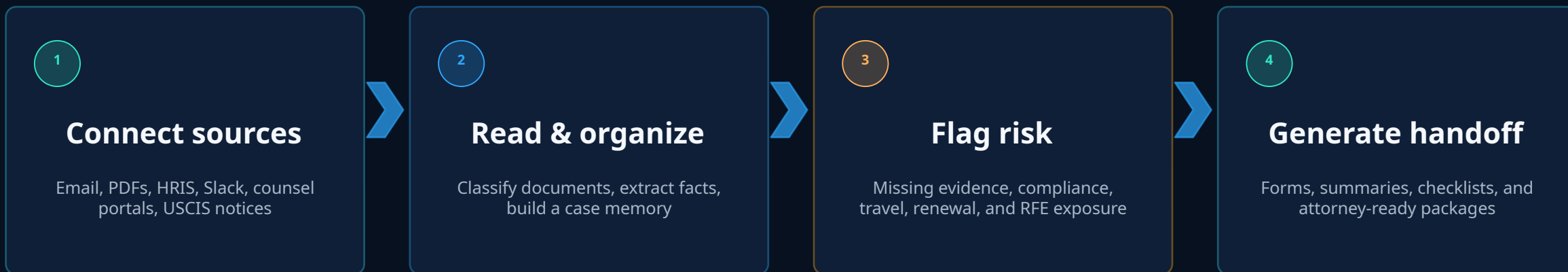
- Shared case workspace for employer, employee, and counsel
- AI document review: missing evidence, inconsistencies, and compliance flags
- Case-specific Q&A across policies, forms, notices, and uploaded docs
- Attorney-ready handoffs: summaries, forms, evidence, and next actions

Lawyers still approve filings. Ellis automates the operational layer around them.



From scattered inputs to attorney-ready output

A case workspace that does the operations work before counsel reviews.



Result: less attorney time spent on coordination, more predictable case throughput, and fewer late surprises.

Shipped in 2 weeks. Customers already paying.

Early usage proves Ellis is solving a real, urgent operational pain.



Trip.com implementation scheduled to begin 07/01/2026.

Trip.com validates the global ops wedge

Ellis is built for the companies whose immigration work spans offices, employees, counsel, and countries.



Signed LOI

\$30k ACV



Converted to paid pilot

Initial rollout: 140 immigration cases



Strategic investor

Jane Sun, Trip.com Group CEO, invested \$35k



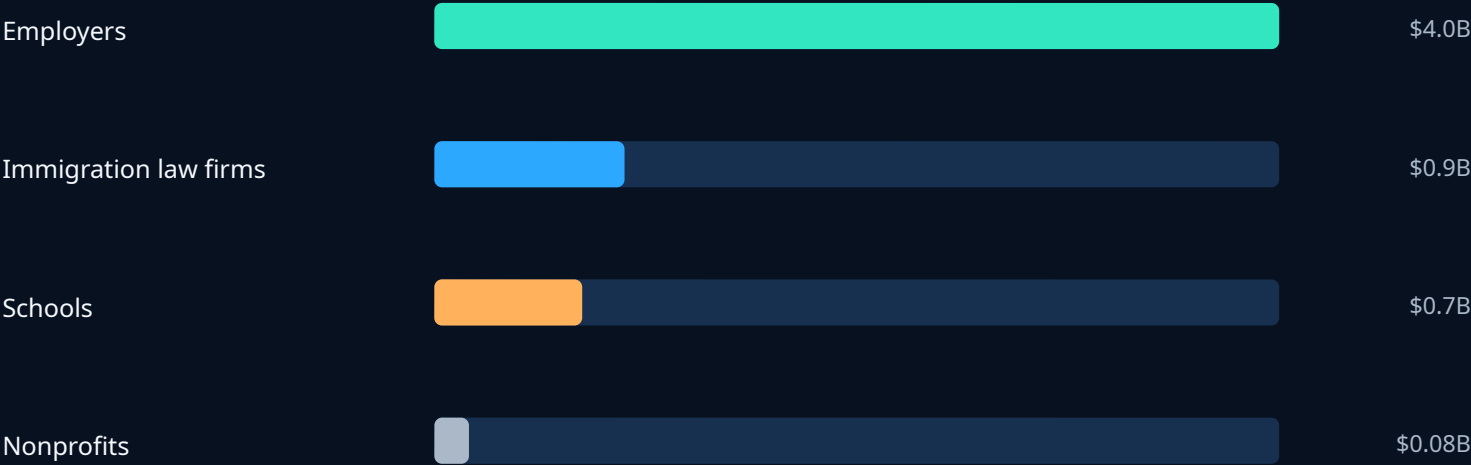
Enterprise immigration is operationally global before it is legally local. Ellis is the shared execution layer.

A \$5.7B US wedge - before global expansion

Bottom-up TAM across employers, law firms, schools, and nonprofits.

\$5.7B

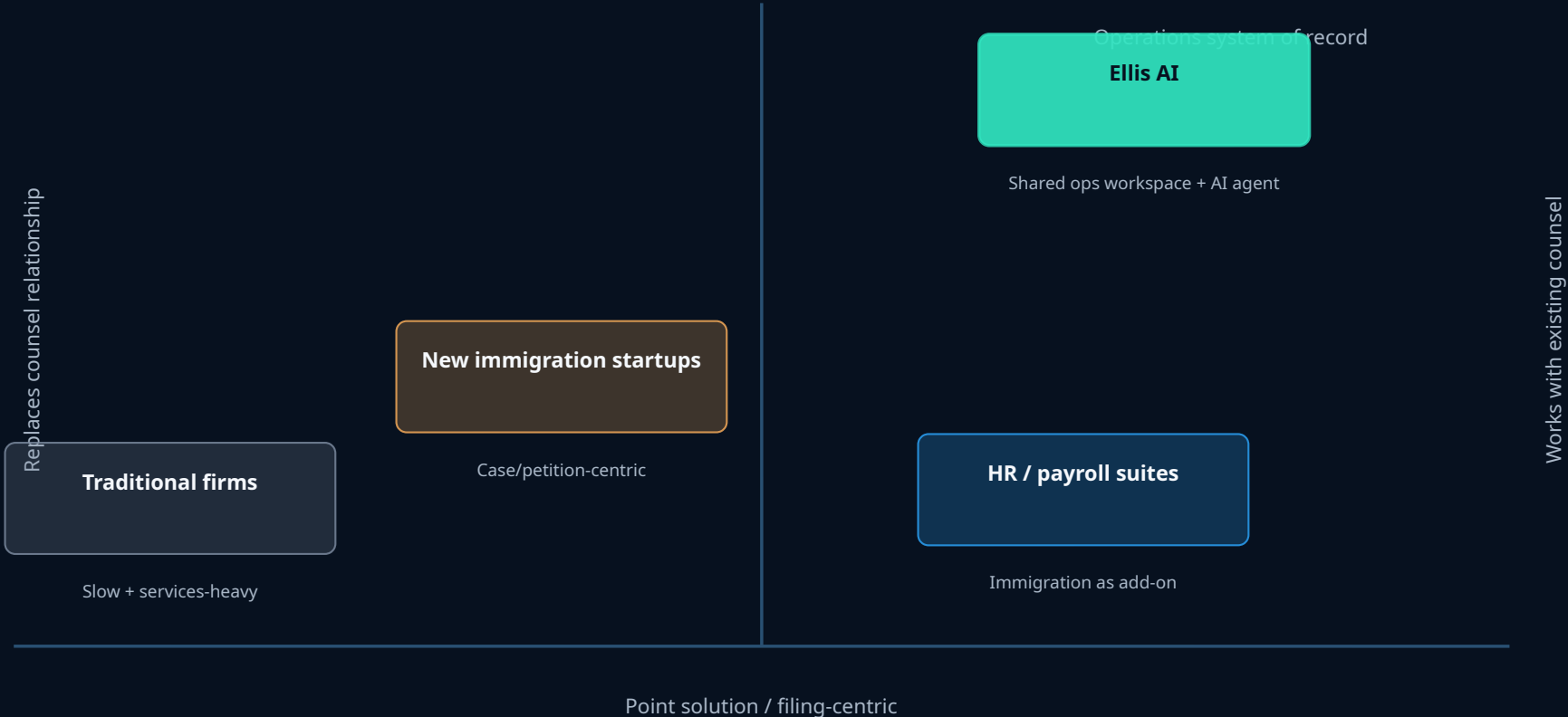
US immigration operations TAM



The initial beachhead is companies and law firms that already pay for immigration workflows, but do not have software that runs the operational layer.

Competitors optimize filings. Ellis runs immigration operations.

The winner is the AI agent that becomes the system of record and action layer.



Founder-led sales into high-pain workflows

Start with urgent operational pain, then expand from case workspace to system of record.

1

Law firms

Paralegal leverage: review docs, summarize notices, prepare handoffs.

2

Startups & mid-market

Coordinate employee cases with existing counsel; reduce costly back-and-forth.

3

Enterprise global ops

Trip.com-style rollout across US and international immigration workflows.

4

Schools & nonprofits

High-volume caseworkers need better operations tooling.

\$50/month pilots -> expand by cases, seats, usage, and enterprise workflows.

Subscription + usage fees aligned to case volume

Ellis monetizes the operating layer while preserving the customer's counsel relationship.



Reference pricing from application assumptions: employers average \$40k ACV; law firms can scale with \$200-\$500 per active case per month.

The system of record becomes the action layer

Once Ellis holds the case memory, it can automate the next action across the immigration lifecycle.



Case graph

Structured history of employees, docs, forms, deadlines, evidence, and risk signals.



Workflow integrations

Email, Slack, HRIS, SSO, storage, counsel workflows, and government notices.



Feedback loop

Each handoff and attorney approval improves routing, risk detection, and benchmarks.



Switching costs

The shared workspace becomes the default place where cases are run.

Ellis can expand from “prep work” into proactive case orchestration.



A technical founder who has lived the stakes

Sammy Abdella built Ellis after experiencing immigration friction as an immigrant, student, researcher, and engineer.



Built all code

MVP built by founder in two weeks; full-time after graduating.



AI + production depth

Columbia AI Lab research, Meta backend, Amazon infrastructure.



Unusual execution

Raised \$60k, signed pilots, and secured Trip.com pilot immediately after launch.



Personal urgency

Rejected Google and Citadel offers to build Ellis full-time.

Columbia CS • Meta • Amazon • AI safety publication • 1590 SAT • Columbia 2027 Commencement Speaker



The AI operating system for global talent mobility

Invest in the action layer that makes immigration faster, cheaper, and safer for companies, employees, and counsel.

- ✓ Urgent pain and clear buyer
- ✓ MVP live with paying pilots
- ✓ Trip.com enterprise validation
- ✓ Founder with deep personal urgency and technical execution

Sammy Abdella, CEO • sn3136@columbia.edu